

Kimchi Bokkeumbap (Kimchi Fried Rice)

Gather Your Ingredients

- ☐ ☐ 1 (8-inch square) sheet gim
- ☐ ☐ 2 tablespoons divided
- ☐ ☐ 2 (1/4-inch-thick) slices deli ham, cut into 1/4-inch pieces (about 4 ounces)
- ☐ ☐ 1 large onion, chopped
- ☐ ☐ 6 scallions, white and green parts separated and sliced thin on bias
- ☐ ☐ 1 1/4 cups cabbage kimchi, drained with 1/4 cup juice reserved, cut into 1/4-inch strips
- ☐ ☐ 1/4 cup water
- ☐ ☐ 4 teaspoons soy sauce
- ☐ ☐ 4 teaspoons gochujang
- ☐ ☐ 1/2 teaspoon pepper
- ☐ ☐ 3 cups cooked short-grain white rice
- ☐ ☐ 4 teaspoons toasted sesame oil
- ☐ ☐ 1 tablespoon sesame seeds, toasted

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Key Equipment



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The Best Kitchen Shears



The Best Nonstick Skillets

Before You Begin

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Bokkeumbap works best with day-old rice; alternatively, cook your rice 2 hours ahead, spread it on a rimmed baking sheet, and let it cool completely before chilling it for 30 minutes. Plain pre-toasted seaweed snacks can be substituted for the gim (seaweed paper); omit the toasting in step 1. You'll need at least a 16-ounce jar of kimchi; if it doesn't yield $\frac{1}{4}$ cup of juice, make up the difference with water. If using soft, well-aged kimchi, omit the water and reduce the cooking time at the end of step 2 to 2 minutes. We developed this recipe with a 12-inch nonstick skillet, but a well-seasoned carbon-steel skillet or 14-inch flat-bottomed wok can be used instead. If desired, top each portion of bokkeumbap with a fried egg.

Instructions

1.

Grip gim with tongs and hold 2 inches above low flame on gas burner. Toast gim, turning every 3 to 5 seconds, until gim is aromatic and shrinks slightly, about 20 seconds. (If you do not have a gas stove, toast gim on rimmed baking sheet in 275-degree oven until gim is aromatic and shrinks slightly, 20 to 25 minutes, flipping gim halfway through toasting.) Using kitchen shears, cut gim into four 2-inch-wide strips. Stack strips and cut crosswise into thin strips.

2.

Heat 1 tablespoon vegetable oil in 12-inch nonstick skillet over medium-high heat until shimmering. Add ham, onion, and scallion whites and cook, stirring frequently, until onion is softened and ham is beginning to

brown at edges, 6 to 8 minutes. Stir in kimchi and reserved juice, water, soy sauce, gochujang, and pepper. Cook, stirring occasionally, until kimchi turns soft and translucent, 4 to 6 minutes.

3.

Add rice; reduce heat to medium-low; and cook, stirring and folding constantly until mixture is evenly coated, about 3 minutes. Stir in sesame oil and remaining 1 tablespoon vegetable oil. Increase heat to medium-high and cook, stirring occasionally, until mixture begins to stick to skillet, about 4 minutes. Transfer to serving bowl. Sprinkle with sesame seeds, scallion greens, and gim and serve.

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